

any place in San Francisco you want to see, for example “Starbucks”, and it pinpoints (literally!) all the Starbucks outlets located in San Francisco.

Now you can click on the “List” tab at the bottom of the screen and it will list the details of all the Starbucks it pointed out. You can click on the one you want to know about and it will show you only that particular Starbucks outlet on the map along with a button for more information about it. In the information panel, if there is a phone number, you can directly place a call to it. Of course, you can zoom into the map with whichever method you prefer and can also view the satellite imagery of any place in the world. That’s about it; it is quite possibly the best implementation of Google Maps on a handheld device.



Handheld tourism on the iPhone

4.2.7 Drawbacks

But don’t whip out that wallet just yet. Just like any electronic product on the market, the iPhone has its own set of drawbacks and you need to take those into account before making a decision.

No Keyboard: Steve Jobs touted the multi-touch user interface, and its ability to make the phone function better than phones with keypads, as the phone’s biggest draw. Admittedly, the multi-touch interface is wicked, the scrolling and pinch-and-zoom will surely be a pleasure to use. The screen also provides virtual feedback in the form of clicking sounds when you tap the screen and a subtle visual effect whenever any button is pressed. The virtual keyboard looks promising, with its ability to correct errors automatically. But a touchscreen can never imitate the feel of tactile feedback that a physical keypad provides. There also seems to be no handwriting recognition on the iPhone (this is unconfirmed, however) and it is impossible to type on the iPhone without actu-